Tool #1:

- **Chapter Readiness Assessment** as a facilitated fillable form that produces an actionable readiness profile. The questions should force useful discussion without becoming another QA audit
  - Microsoft Forms, SurveyMonkey, Jotform, fillable PDF, etc.

Chapter Readiness Assessment

FAME Chapter Depth Implementation Guide

Form introduction

Purpose

The Chapter Readiness Assessment helps chapter leadership evaluate the conditions that will support successful employer expansion. Complete the assessment before beginning a concentrated employer recruitment effort.

The assessment examines six areas that directly influence a chapter's ability to grow:

Employer Engagement • Leadership & Governance • College Capacity • Student Pipeline • Employer Recruitment Infrastructure • Resources & Ownership

The results should be used to identify strengths, surface potential barriers, and establish priority actions for the chapter's employer expansion strategy.

Who should complete it?

Complete the assessment collaboratively whenever possible. Recommended participants include:

- Chapter president and/or officers
- College leadership or FAME program representative
- FAME instructor
- FAME coordinator/Student Success Coach
- Hub organization representative, if applicable
- Representatives from active sponsoring employers

Recommended approach: Bring the group together and submit **one assessment representing the chapter's collective response**, rather than collecting individual surveys. The discussion itself is part of the assessment.

Estimated time: 45–60 minutes

Section 1 — Chapter Information

1. Chapter Name

Type: Short text
Required: Yes

2. Person completing/submitting this assessment

Type: Short text
Required: Yes

3. Assessment date

Type: Date
Required: Yes

4. Who participated in completing the assessment?

Type: Check all that apply

- Chapter President
- Other Chapter Officer(s)
- Employer Representative(s)
- College Leadership
- FAME Instructor
- FAME Coordinator/Student Success Coach
- Hub Organization
- Other

5. Current number of active sponsoring employers

Type: Number

6. Current number of students

Type: Number fields

First-year cohort: ___
Second-year cohort: ___
Other/current additional cohorts, if applicable: ___

7. What is driving the chapter's current interest in employer expansion?

Type: Long text

Prompt: Briefly describe the opportunity, challenge, or need that has prompted the chapter to pursue additional employer partners.

8. What is your preliminary employer growth goal?

Type: Number

Number of additional sponsoring employers the chapter would like to add: ___

9. What is your preliminary student growth goal?

Type: Number or short text

Number of additional student sponsorships/seats the chapter would like to support: ___

How to Answer the Readiness Questions

Use the following response scale throughout the assessment.

Fully in Place

The chapter has an established practice, resource, or capacity in this area. It is functioning consistently and can support expansion.

Partially in Place

Some elements exist, but improvement, clarification, or additional capacity is needed to support expansion.

Needs Development

A meaningful gap exists that should be addressed as part of the chapter's expansion strategy.

Unsure / Needs Discussion

The group does not currently have enough information or agreement to assess this item.

I prefer **Needs Development** over "Not Yet." It creates a better diagnostic output and doesn't imply every item has to be completely resolved before recruitment can begin.

Section 2 — Employer Engagement

Section introduction

Evaluate the current level of participation and shared ownership among existing sponsoring employers. A growing chapter will place additional demands on employer leadership, decision-making, recruitment, and chapter activities.

Rate each statement:

10. Existing sponsoring employers regularly participate in chapter meetings.

Fully in Place / Partially in Place / Needs Development / Unsure

11. Employers actively participate in chapter decisions and provide input on chapter direction.

Same scale.

12. Employers participate in student recruitment and selection activities.

Same scale.

13. Employers contribute to chapter activities beyond sponsoring their individual students.

Same scale.

14. Chapter responsibilities are distributed across multiple employer partners.

Same scale.

15. Communication with employers is consistent and employers know what is expected of them.

Same scale.

16. Current employers generally view their participation in FAME as valuable to their organization.

Same scale.

Reflection

17. Which employers currently demonstrate the strongest engagement, and what does their engagement look like?
Long text

18. Where could employer engagement improve before or during expansion?
Long text

Section 3 — Leadership & Governance

Section introduction

Consider whether the chapter has the leadership structure and operating practices necessary to support additional employers and students.

Rate each statement:

19. Chapter officer roles and responsibilities are clearly defined.

20. Chapter leadership responsibilities are distributed across multiple people and organizations.

21. Active committees or working groups support key chapter functions.

22. Chapter bylaws are current and reflect how the chapter currently operates.

23. The chapter has a clear and consistently followed decision-making process.

24. Leadership succession has been discussed and potential future leaders are being developed.

25. Important chapter information, documents, contacts, and processes are accessible beyond one individual.

26. The chapter has sufficient leadership capacity to manage employer expansion alongside normal chapter operations.

All use the same four-option scale.

Reflection

27. If one or two key chapter leaders stepped away tomorrow, what activities or knowledge would be most at risk?
Long text

28. What leadership or governance improvements would make expansion easier to manage?
Long text

Section 4 — College Capacity

Section introduction

Employer expansion should be considered alongside the college's ability to support additional students while maintaining the quality of the FAME experience.

Capacity Snapshot

29. What is the chapter's current annual student capacity?
Number

30. Approximately how many additional students could the college accommodate with its current resources?
Number + "Unsure"

Rate each statement:

31. Classroom capacity can support the chapter's anticipated growth.

32. FTC/lab space and equipment can support anticipated growth.

33. Instructor capacity is sufficient to support anticipated growth.

34. The college can maintain the required FAME schedule as enrollment increases.

35. Student support and coordination capacity can scale with enrollment.

36. College leadership understands and supports the chapter's employer expansion goals.

37. The college has identified the point at which additional students would require added instructors, equipment, space, scheduling changes, or other resources.

Same scale.

Reflection

38. What is currently the greatest constraint on increasing student capacity?
Long text

39. What investments or operational changes may be required if the chapter grows?
Long text

This is an important question. A chapter could successfully recruit ten employers and then discover the college can only accommodate six additional students. The assessment should surface that before a target is finalized.

Section 5 — Student Recruitment Pipeline

Section introduction

Additional employer sponsorship capacity must be supported by a sufficient pipeline of qualified students.

40. Which student recruitment channels does the chapter currently use?

Type: Check all that apply

- High schools
- Career/technical education programs
- Career centers
- Employer referrals
- College recruitment
- Community events
- Manufacturing Day
- Social media/digital marketing
- Current student or alumni referrals
- Other

Rate each statement:

41. The chapter consistently generates enough qualified applicants to fill available opportunities.

42. Student recruitment activities follow an established annual calendar.

43. The chapter has active relationships with high schools, career centers, counselors, or other student referral partners.

44. Employers actively participate in student recruitment.

45. Current student-facing recruitment materials accurately represent the FAME experience.

46. The chapter could generate additional qualified applicants if employer sponsorship capacity increased.

47. The chapter understands which student recruitment activities produce the strongest candidates.

Same scale.

Reflection

48. If the chapter added new sponsoring employers today, would the current student pipeline be sufficient to fill the additional opportunities?

- Yes
- Probably
- Probably not
- No
- Unsure

49. What would need to change to support a larger student pipeline?
Long text

Section 6 — Employer Recruitment Infrastructure

Section introduction

Evaluate whether the chapter currently has the tools, information, and processes needed to conduct an organized employer recruitment campaign.

50. Which resources currently exist?

Check all that apply

- Employer prospect list
- Employer recruitment presentation/pitch deck
- Employer-facing one-pager
- Employer testimonials
- Graduate/student success stories
- Employer ROI/business-case information
- Outreach email templates
- Employer FAQ
- Prospect tracker/CRM

- Employer evaluation process
- Company site visit process
- Employer onboarding materials
- Recruitment calendar
- None of the above

Rate each statement:

Fully in Place / Partially in Place / Needs Development / Unsure / Needs Discussion

51. The chapter has identified a meaningful pool of prospective employers in the region.

52. Prospective employers can be prioritized based on fit and workforce need.

53. Chapter representatives can clearly communicate the employer value proposition.

54. A process exists for tracking employer outreach and follow-up.

55. A consistent process exists for moving an interested company from initial conversation through chapter consideration.

56. The chapter has a defined process for evaluating employer readiness, including safety and mentorship capacity.

57. Current chapter leaders have relationships that could create warm introductions to prospective employers.

Reflection

58. Approximately how many prospective employers could you identify today?

- Fewer than 5
- 5–10
- 11–25
- 26–50
- More than 50
- Unsure

59. What is the greatest current barrier to employer recruitment?
Long text

Section 7 — Resources & Ownership

This is one of the most important sections based on what surfaced during the chapter-depth discussions. Recruitment requires someone to consistently own the work; otherwise, it gets absorbed into everyone's existing responsibilities and loses momentum.

60. Who will serve as the primary owner of the chapter's employer expansion effort?

Short text

Name: ___
Organization: ___
Role: ___

61. Has this individual agreed to serve in this role?

- Yes
- Not yet
- To be determined

Rate each statement:

Fully in Place / Partially in Place / Needs Development / Unsure / Needs Discussion

62. A specific individual has responsibility for coordinating employer expansion.

63. Chapter leadership has sufficient time available to conduct consistent outreach and follow-up.

64. Responsibilities for prospecting, outreach, employer meetings, marketing, college coordination, onboarding, and tracking can be clearly assigned.

65. The chapter has access to adequate marketing and communications support.

66. Resources are available to support the chapter's expansion strategy.

67. Chapter leadership has established a regular cadence for reviewing recruitment progress.

68. Which additional resources would most improve your ability to expand?

Select up to three

- Dedicated staff/recruiter time
- Marketing support

- Employer recruitment materials
- Prospect/contact information
- Funding
- Employer events
- Data/ROI information
- FAME USA coaching
- Peer chapter support
- College staff capacity
- Employer onboarding support
- Other

Section 8 — Overall Readiness

This is where I would **avoid having the software calculate an arbitrary readiness percentage**. Have the group make a judgment after completing the assessment.

69. Based on your discussion, how would you characterize the chapter's overall readiness?

Ready to Begin
The chapter has the capacity and infrastructure needed to begin employer expansion. Identified improvements can be addressed during implementation.

Ready with Priority Actions
The chapter can begin selected expansion activities while addressing several identified gaps.

Build Capacity First
One or more significant conditions should be strengthened before launching a concentrated employer recruitment campaign.

Additional Discussion Needed
The chapter needs additional information or stakeholder alignment before determining readiness.

Section 9 — Priority Action Plan

This section is essential. The form should **produce a plan**, rather than end with the readiness designation.

70. What are the three most important issues identified through this assessment?

Priority 1: ___
Priority 2: ___
Priority 3: ___

Then repeat the following for each priority:

What action will be taken?
Long text

Who owns this action?
Short text

Target completion date:
Date

What support or resources are needed?
Long text

Section 10 — Confirm the Expansion Goal

Now that the chapter has assessed its capacity, ask them to revisit the preliminary goal they entered at the beginning.

71. Based on this assessment, what is the chapter's employer expansion goal?

Add ___ new sponsoring employers by ___

72. What additional student sponsorship capacity would this create?

___ additional sponsorships

73. Can the college and student pipeline realistically support this goal?

- Yes
- Yes, with identified changes
- Additional planning is required

74. Who is accountable for overall implementation?

Name: ___
Organization: ___

Final Submission Summary

Your Chapter's Next Step

Your completed assessment should be used to develop your **Chapter Depth Implementation Plan**.

Before beginning the next phase, chapter leadership should have:

☐ Confirmed the employer expansion goal
☐ Identified priority readiness actions
☐ Assigned an expansion lead
☐ Assigned owners to readiness actions
☐ Confirmed college capacity
☐ Confirmed the student pipeline can support anticipated growth
☐ Established a target completion date